

didn't heat up much, so the thermals are also in-check all the time.

Now, while we are at performance, it is also important to mention software. Also, because this is where Vivo has impressed me the most (apart from the camera of course). With smartphones becoming stagnant each passing day, it is becoming more and more important for brands to act on feedback. This year, the Vivo X100 Pro comes with one of the best implementations of Vivo's FunTouch OS. The setup process is easy, there is pretty much no bloatware, and I can finally open the camera by double-pressing the volume button! The only thing left to do is offer more Android updates since 3 years of OS and 4 years of security updates sounds less for a Rs 90,000 smartphone.

Battery of the Vivo X100 Pro has been pretty good recently. The smartphone easily pushes 6-7 hours of on-screen time for a user like myself who at times games or edits stuff on the fly. This, mainly because Vivo has gone a bit away from the industry standard and put a larger 5,400mAh battery on the X100 Pro. Now, of course, given the amount of camera tech that has been jammed into this device, a bigger battery was the need of the hour, in case people unleash their inner creator, but for a normal user, it works even better since we have AMOLED LTPO tech to save battery, super fast 100W charging to juice it up quicker, and a bigger unit to manage all of that. Win.

CAMERA

Coming to the hero of the story. The main attraction. The Vivo-Zeiss collab has gotten ahead this time around. This year, we get a similar primary 1-inch type Sony IMX989 shooter, a 50-megapixel wide-angle shooter, and another 50-megapixel periscope telephoto lens. This camera module doesn't just take good photos, it takes smartphone photography to a new level. We are well aware of Vivo's collaboration with Zeiss in developing the smartphone cameras and this year, the brands have come quite far with just how much the camera offers.

To start with, we get this multifocal feature similar to the iPhone 15 Pro

Max, but with 12 preset focal lengths as compared to the seven presets on the iPhone. This is something you will use a lot to change perspectives while taking pictures. From 16mm ultra-wide, to 600mm, which is close to 24x zoom, the quality of photos in each focal length is outstanding. Even with the 24.3x digital zoom, the Vivo X100 Pro is able to click very sharp images, which by no means look like they have been clicked at this zoom level.

Not just this, the Vivo X100 Pro's 10X optical zoom is right up there with Samsung's 10X optical with the Galaxy S23 Ultra. I had quite a lot of fun using the telephoto periscope lens.

Now, we don't just get the multi focal feature in the default camera app, you also get 5 presets in portrait mode - from 24mm to 100mm. The range is great, and the quality of portraits in each of these focal lengths is outstanding. Vivo X100 Pro's portraits are also where we see Vivo and Zeiss' combined genius in action. The Zeiss portrait modes and effects add quite a lot of variety, enough to make a wannabe smartphone photographer like me also feel like I'm doing great.

Now, apart from the great portraits and zoom capabilities, the Vivo X100 Pro also does a lot in the background to retain detail and manage light in images. Since the smartphone is using a 1-inch type sensor which takes in more light, managing lens flare is highly important. For this, the Vivo X100 Pro has the T* (T-star) coating which manages lens flare.

Apart from this, we get some more tech, like the floating elements in the periscope telephoto lens, which is APO certified, making it easier for us to take those sun shots, managing contrast and retaining details on the edges on higher zoom levels.

So the camera is great, to say the least. This is easily one of the best camera that I used in 2023 (yes, I used it before New Year's), and it offers so much to play around with that it is tough for me to even put it in words. For example, the cinematic portrait and the video capabilities of the Vivo X100 Pro is also amazing

and we get more than decent enough footage to use for mobile consumption.

VERDICT

So the Vivo X100 Pro is nothing short of a photography enthusiast's phone. We get so much to play around with the camera, that even a detailed review doesn't feel long enough to mention and tell you about each and everything that this smartphone does. One of the best cameras that I have tested in the recent past, easy. With that, we get quite a lot of might with the powerful MediaTek Dimensity 9300, and a brilliant display.

The only thing that had to be sacrificed for stuffing all that tech within the 8.9mm thick frame is the ergonomics. I honestly didn't like the design much as compared to last year's Vivo X90 Pro, but the much larger camera module makes it obvious as to why there could have been limitations around the design and keeping it within the design language the brand uses for its flagship series phones.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 164.1 x 75.3 x 8.9 mm or 9.1 mm | Weight: 221 g or 225 g (7.80 oz) | Build: Glass front, aluminum frame, glass back | SIM: Nano-SIM, eSIM or Dual SIM (Nano-SIM, dual stand-by) | IP68 dust/water resistant (up to 1.5m for 30 min) | Display Type: LTPO AMOLED, 1B colors, 120Hz, 3000 nits (peak) | Display Size: 6.78 inches, 111.5 cm² (~90.2% screen-to-body ratio) | Display Resolution: 1260 x 2800 pixels, 20:9 ratio (~452 ppi density) | OS: Android 14, FunTouch 14 (International), OriginOS 4 (China) | Chipset: MediaTek Dimensity 9300 (4 nm) | CPU: Octa-core (1x3.25 GHz Cortex-X4 & 3x2.85 GHz Cortex-X4 & 4x2.0 GHz Cortex-A720) | GPU: Immortalis-G720 MC12 | MEMORY: Card slot | Internal: 256GB 12GB RAM, 256GB 16GB RAM, 512GB 16GB RAM, 1TB 16GB RAM | MAIN CAMERA: 50 MP, f/1.8, 23mm (wide), 1/0.98", 1.6µm, PDAF, Laser AF, OIS; 50 MP, f/2.5, 100mm (periscope telephoto), 1/2", 0.7µm, PDAF (18cm - ∞), OIS, 4.3x optical zoom; 50 MP, f/2.0, 15mm, 119° (ultrawide), 1/2.76", 0.64µm, AF | Features: Zeiss optics, Zeiss T* lens coating, LED flash, panorama, HDR, 3D LUT import | Video: 8K@30fps, 4K@30/60fps, 1080p, gyro-EIS, Cinematic mode (4K) | SELFIE CAMERA: 32 MP, f/2.0, 20mm (ultrawide) | Features: HDR | Video: 1080p@30/60fps

CONTACT

Phone: 1800-208-3388 | Website: vivo.com/in/